

# Vertiv Holdings

## Business Development Dossier

|                              |                                             |
|------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Industry                     | Data Center Infrastructure / Critical Power |
| Revenue                      | \$10.2B                                     |
| Employees                    | 34,000                                      |
| Ideal Customer Profile Score | 88                                          |

### ICP SCORING MODEL



**ICP = Signals + Revenue + Employees + Fit (max 100)**

|                  |                                                                                                                             |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Signals (0-35)   | Top 4 signals scored; each = base(60%) + recency bonus<br><30d: 40%   <90d: 30%   <180d: 20%   older: 10%                   |
| Revenue (0-25)   | \$500M-\$10B sweet spot -> 70-100% of 25 pts<br>Below \$500M -> pro-rata x 0.5   Above \$10B -> 60%                         |
| Employees (0-20) | 2,000+ preferred (70-100%)   500-2K partial (50-70%)<br>Below 500 -> pro-rata x 0.3                                         |
| Fit (0-20)       | High-fit types: reorg, transformation, M&A, hiring,<br>funding, partnership -> 5 pts ea (max 12) + diversity 2/type (max 8) |

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### McChrystal Group

Leadership Advisory & Organizational Effectiveness

## SECTION 1

## Organization Snapshot

**Legal Name** Vertiv Holdings Co

**Headquarters** Westerville, Ohio

**Founded** 2016

**Ownership**

Public (NYSE: VRT); formerly Emerson Network Power, acquired by Platinum Equity (2016), went public via SPAC (2020). Widely held institutional ownership.

**Footprint**

Global manufacturing in Americas, EMEA, and Asia-Pacific; 34,000 employees across 30+ countries; major manufacturing sites in U.S., Mexico, Italy, India, China; R&D centers worldwide

## SECTION 1b

## Company Overview

Vertiv designs, manufactures, and services critical digital infrastructure for data centers, communication networks, and commercial/industrial environments. Originally Emerson Network Power (acquired by Platinum Equity in 2016), Vertiv went public in 2020 and has experienced explosive 28% revenue growth to \$10.2B driven by AI data center demand, with a \$15B backlog and major acquisitions totaling \$1.2B.

## SECTION 2

## Financial Health & Growth Stage

*Understanding Vertiv Holdings's financial position and trajectory is critical to framing any engagement conversation.*

Revenue: \$10.2B in 2025, up 28% YoY. Q4 2025 revenue \$2.6B (+29% YoY). Orders surged 252% YoY.

Profitability: Adjusted EBITDA margins expanding; strong operating leverage on revenue growth. R&D spend \$442M (4.3% of sales).

Backlog: \$15B - providing multi-year revenue visibility. 89%+ of 2026 revenue tied to firm contracts.

Capital Allocation: Capex rising to 3-4% of sales (above historical 2%) to expand manufacturing. Acquisitions: PurgeRite (\$1B), Great Lakes (\$200M).

Analyst Sentiment: Bullish. Stock has been a top performer. Key question: can the company scale operations fast enough to convert the massive backlog into revenue without quality issues?

Key Pressures: Manufacturing capacity constraints; supply chain bottlenecks; talent acquisition in competitive labor market; integration of two acquisitions during hypergrowth; customer delivery timelines.

Key Tailwinds: AI infrastructure spending creating secular demand; data center construction boom; energy transition (grid-scale power); product leadership in liquid cooling technology.

### SECTION 3

## Leadership Team Profiles

*The following contacts are recommended as primary outreach targets - champion-level leaders who feel the organizational pain daily and can sponsor McChrystal internally.*

### **Anand Sanghi - President, Americas [INFERRED] [PRIORITY TARGET]**

Leads largest regional business during peak growth

*Outreach rationale: Leads the largest and fastest-growing region - directly responsible for scaling operations, integrating acquisitions, and managing the \$15B backlog conversion. Feels the organizational coordination challenge most acutely as manufacturing, supply chain, engineering, and installation must all scale in sync.*

### **SVP of Global Operations - SVP, Global Operations [INFERRED] [PRIORITY TARGET]**

Oversees manufacturing expansion across all regions

*Outreach rationale: Owns the manufacturing scaling challenge - expanding capacity 50%+ while maintaining quality and integrating PurgeRite and Great Lakes operations. The coordination between new factory buildouts, acquisition integration, and existing production is the core McChrystal engagement opportunity.*

*Additional leadership team members relevant to the engagement:*

### **Giordano Albertazzi - Chief Executive Officer**

Former president of Vertiv Americas; deep industry experience in critical infrastructure

### **David Fallon - Chief Financial Officer**

Financial leadership during hypergrowth phase; manages investor expectations

### **Karsten Winther - President, EMEA [INFERRED]**

Leads European operations including Italian manufacturing base

### SECTION 4

## Organizational Culture & Structure

*Culture and structure are often where McChrystal Group finds the deepest leverage. The following signals indicate how Vertiv Holdings operates today and where friction exists.*

### **Organizational Structure**

Regional operating model (Americas, EMEA, APAC) with global product lines and technology platforms. Manufacturing is globally distributed. R&D centralized. The rapid growth is testing the matrix structure - regional leaders need manufacturing capacity that global functions control, creating coordination friction.

### **Culture Signals**

Hypergrowth Culture: Vertiv's culture is defined by the AI boom - a sense of urgency, opportunity, and 'building

the future.' This creates energy but also burnout risk as employees absorb 28% growth plus acquisitions.

Manufacturing Heritage: Core DNA is engineering and manufacturing excellence (from Emerson roots). The cultural challenge: scaling manufacturing culture to accommodate AI-era speed of decision-making.

Integration Strain: PurgeRite (\$1B) and Great Lakes (\$200M) acquisitions bring new teams and capabilities that must be integrated during the busiest period in company history. Attention is divided between growth and integration.

Glassdoor: [INFERRED] Likely positive overall given stock performance and growth opportunity; concerns about pace of change and work-life balance during hypergrowth.

## SECTION 5

### Recent News & Trigger Events

*The following developments from the past 18 months create urgency and provide natural conversation entry points for engaging Vertiv Holdings.*

**1. 2025-12-01 - Acquired PurgeRite for \$1B - mechanical flushing and filtration services for data centers**

Largest acquisition in company history, during highest-growth period - integration competes with organic growth for leadership bandwidth

**2. 2025-08-01 - Acquired Great Lakes Data Racks for \$200M - custom rack enclosure manufacturer**

Second major acquisition in 4 months - compounds integration complexity

**3. 2025-12-01 - Revenue crossed \$10B milestone; orders up 252% YoY; backlog reached \$15B**

Hypergrowth creates organizational scaling pressure - systems and processes designed for a \$7B company strain at \$10B+

**4. 2026-01-01 - Capex guidance raised to 3-4% of sales for manufacturing expansion (above historical 2%)**

New factory construction requires cross-functional coordination between real estate, engineering, supply chain, HR, and production - a McChrystal alignment challenge

**5. 2025-06-01 - Workforce scaled from ~28,000 to 34,000 employees - 21% headcount growth in 18 months**

Rapid hiring at this scale strains onboarding, culture transmission, and organizational coherence

## SECTION 6

### McChrystal Fit Assessment

*Extremely strong organizational need (hypergrowth + acquisitions + manufacturing expansion) but the 'if it ain't broke' dynamic is real - 28% growth makes it hard to argue for intervention. Rating moves to Strong if backlog conversion delays or quality issues emerge, or if integration friction becomes visible. The window is now - before growth problems compound - but the sale requires framing around 'sustaining success' not 'fixing problems.'*

## Primary Problem

Scaling a \$7B company to \$10B+ in 2 years while integrating \$1.2B in acquisitions, building new factories, hiring 6,000 employees, and converting a \$15B backlog into delivered projects - without quality failures that would damage reputation in the mission-critical data center market.

## Best McChrystal Capability Fit

Team of Teams for hyper-scaling organizations - Vertiv's challenge is coordinating growth across multiple dimensions (manufacturing, acquisition integration, workforce scaling, product innovation) simultaneously. McChrystal's operating rhythm prevents these growth vectors from colliding and ensures they reinforce each other.

## Likely Objections to Engagement

We're growing 28% - things are working, why change?  
Focus is on execution speed, not organizational design  
Budget allocated to capex and acquisitions, not advisory  
Engineering-centric culture may undervalue organizational consulting

## Competitive Advisory Landscape

McKinsey Operations Practice - manufacturing scaling and supply chain optimization  
BCG - growth strategy and organizational design  
Deloitte - IT systems scaling and digital transformation  
Internal: Vertiv has built its own operating model through Emerson heritage

## SECTION 7

## Conversation Entry Points

*These questions are designed for a Senior Partner's first conversation. Each opens a thread that naturally leads to McChrystal Group's capabilities without a direct pitch.*

### 1. With orders up 252% and a \$15B backlog, what's the binding constraint on converting that backlog into delivered revenue - manufacturing capacity, talent, or organizational coordination?

Start with the business problem they care about most (backlog conversion) and surface the organizational dimension. Most leaders answer 'manufacturing' but the real answer is coordination.

### 2. How is the PurgeRite integration going alongside the organic growth? When everything is a priority, how do you decide what gets leadership attention first?

Surface the priority collision between acquisition integration and organic growth - this is the organizational design question that determines value creation.

## Recommended Meeting Framing

Frame as a conversation about what other hyper-scaling companies (military, tech) have learned about the moment when growth outpaces organizational systems. Not 'something is wrong' but 'something breaks at \$10B

that worked at \$7B.' McChrystal's pattern recognition from scaling JSOC is the credibility anchor.

## SECTION 8

# Brand Insights & Market Positioning

*Brand strategy reveals organizational priorities and coordination challenges. The following analysis connects Vertiv Holdings's market positioning to potential McChrystal engagement opportunities.*

**Market Position:** Vertiv is the clear technology leader in critical digital infrastructure - particularly in liquid cooling for AI data centers, where demand is unprecedented. The Vertiv brand carries engineering credibility.

**Brand Evolution:** Transitioning from 'Emerson Network Power' (industrial conglomerate division) to 'Vertiv' (AI-era infrastructure company) - a significant brand elevation. The AI demand wave has naturally repositioned the brand.

**Brand Threats:** Quality failures in mission-critical infrastructure (power, cooling for data centers) would be catastrophic to reputation. Growth that outpaces quality control is the primary brand risk.

**McChrystal Connection:** The brand promise of 'keeping critical infrastructure running' depends entirely on operational coordination - manufacturing, installation, service, and support must all scale in sync. A broken coordination link means a data center goes down.

## SECTION 9

# Deep McChrystal Group Fit Analysis

*This is the strategic case for pursuing Vertiv Holdings. It synthesizes findings from all previous sections into a comprehensive engagement thesis with specific fit dimensions, expected outcomes, stakeholder mapping, and a phased pursuit strategy.*

## 9a. Fit Dimensions

### Fit Dimension 1: Hypergrowth Organizational Scaling

Growing 28% annually while adding 6,000 employees requires organizational systems that most companies never need. Meeting cadences, decision-making authorities, information flows, and coordination mechanisms that work at \$7B break at \$10B. McChrystal's operating model addresses this by building adaptive coordination architecture. BCG designs organization charts; McChrystal builds the operating rhythm that makes the chart function under hypergrowth stress.

### Fit Dimension 2: Acquisition Integration During Hypergrowth

Integrating PurgeRite (\$1B) and Great Lakes (\$200M) while simultaneously growing 28% organically is the organizational equivalent of building a new wing on a house while the rest is under renovation. Leadership attention is the scarce resource. McChrystal's cadence management ensures integration and growth each get systematic attention rather than competing.

### Fit Dimension 3: Manufacturing Scaling Coordination

New factories require synchronized execution across real estate, construction, equipment procurement, hiring, training, supply chain setup, and production ramp - all on aggressive timelines driven by backlog commitments. This is a cross-functional coordination challenge where delays compound exponentially. McChrystal's execution architecture prevents the cascading delays that typical matrix organizations experience.

#### 9b. Cumulative Case

Vertiv represents the positive version of organizational stress: growth-driven rather than crisis-driven. The signal chain: AI demand explosion -> 252% order growth -> \$15B backlog -> manufacturing capacity constraints -> \$1.2B acquisitions to add capability -> workforce scaling 21% -> capex surge for new factories -> all must execute simultaneously without quality failures. Revenue potential: \$350K initial (operating rhythm assessment for hypergrowth), \$1M-\$1.5M deployment, \$300K ongoing. Total: \$1.5M-\$2.5M over 18 months.

#### 9c. Enterprise Issues

1. Backlog Conversion Bottleneck: \$15B backlog means nothing if manufacturing can't deliver. Cross-functional coordination between orders, engineering, procurement, manufacturing, and installation is the rate-limiting step.
2. Acquisition Integration Attention Deficit: PurgeRite and Great Lakes teams must integrate while every leader is consumed by organic growth. Integration tasks get pushed to 'next quarter' until cultural drift makes integration harder.
3. Quality Risk During Hypergrowth: Data centers are mission-critical. A cooling failure means a customer's AI training run goes down. Quality systems designed for moderate growth may not catch defects at 28% growth rates.
4. Talent Onboarding at Scale: 6,000 new employees in 18 months - many in manufacturing roles requiring specialized skills. Onboarding velocity versus training quality is a real tradeoff.
5. Regional Coordination Gaps: Americas, EMEA, and APAC regions compete for constrained manufacturing capacity. Without explicit coordination, global priorities suffer from regional optimization.

#### 9d. Expected Outcomes

1. Backlog Conversion Acceleration: Cross-functional operating rhythm that synchronizes orders, engineering, and manufacturing. Measurable: 15%+ improvement in on-time delivery rate.
2. Parallel Integration and Growth: Operating cadence that gives acquisition integration systematic leadership attention. Measurable: PurgeRite integration milestones on-track within 6 months.
3. Quality Assurance During Scaling: Organizational mechanisms that maintain quality discipline during hypergrowth. Measurable: defect rates maintained within historical norms despite volume growth.
4. Manufacturing Expansion Coordination: Cross-functional execution architecture for new factory buildouts. Measurable: new factory time-to-production reduced by 20%.
5. Global Resource Allocation: Transparent prioritization framework for regional capacity allocation. Measurable: reduce regional escalations by 40%.

## 9e. Key Stakeholders & Business Unit Map

### Office of the CEO

Leader: Giordano Albertazzi, CEO  
 Function: Enterprise strategy, growth management  
 McChrystal Relevance: Executive sponsor

### Americas

Leader: Anand Sanghi [INFERRED], President  
 Function: Largest region, peak growth  
 McChrystal Relevance: Priority: Backlog conversion, capacity scaling

### EMEA

Leader: Karsten Winther [INFERRED], President  
 Function: European manufacturing, growth  
 McChrystal Relevance: Regional coordination

### APAC

Leader: [Regional President]  
 Function: Asian manufacturing, emerging markets  
 McChrystal Relevance: Regional coordination

### Global Operations

Leader: SVP Ops [INFERRED]  
 Function: Manufacturing expansion, quality  
 McChrystal Relevance: Priority: Factory scaling, integration

### Finance

Leader: David Fallon, CFO  
 Function: Capital allocation, investor management  
 McChrystal Relevance: Budget for advisory engagement

### R&D/Technology

Leader: [CTO]  
 Function: Product innovation, liquid cooling, AI  
 McChrystal Relevance: Product-manufacturing coordination

## 9f. Opportunity Thesis

Strategic Signal Convergence - Why Now: AI demand explosion -> 252% order surge -> \$15B backlog -> manufacturing capacity constraints -> \$1.2B acquisitions -> 21% workforce growth -> capex surge. The convergence creates the 12-month window where organizational coordination becomes the binding constraint on value creation - not technology, not demand, not capital.

The Structural Paradox - Why McChrystal, Not McKinsey: McKinsey optimizes supply chains. Deloitte scales IT systems. BCG designs organization structures. But the challenge is coordination speed under hypergrowth - making sure the new factory, the acquisition integration, the talent ramp, and the backlog conversion all execute in sync rather than competing. McChrystal builds the operating rhythm that coordinates parallel execution streams. Military credibility: 'scaling JSOC during the Iraq surge' is the direct analog for scaling Vertiv during the AI surge.



### Phased Engagement:

- Phase 1 (\$350K-\$450K, 3 months): Operating rhythm assessment - map coordination gaps in backlog conversion process; pilot cross-functional cadence for one product line or region.
- Phase 2 (\$700K-\$1M, 6 months): Enterprise deployment across regions; acquisition integration cadence; manufacturing expansion coordination.
- Phase 3 (\$300K-\$500K retainer): Ongoing hypergrowth management cadence.

### Multi-Threaded Pursuit Map:

- Thread 1: Regional President (Americas) - backlog conversion pain. Angle: "What's the coordination bottleneck between orders and delivery?"
- Thread 2: SVP Global Operations - manufacturing scaling. Angle: "How do you build new factories while running existing ones at capacity?"
- Thread 3: CEO via board/industry connections - executive framing. Angle: "McChrystal helped scale JSOC during the Iraq surge. The organizational challenge is the same: exponential demand growth that outpaces organizational capacity."